

How a ROAS campaign actually works

What it is, how Meta structures it, which events get fired back to the ad platform, and exactly how the **\$400 / +\$900 / +\$2,700** value ladder plays out across your funnel.

Meta Ads

Conversions API

Segment

Amplitude

Snowflake

Read top-to-bottom, or jump to §4 for the Wonderly ladder.

01

What "ROAS campaign" means

ROAS = **Return On Ad Spend**. A "ROAS campaign" is shorthand for a campaign where you tell Meta to optimize for **the dollar value your conversions are worth**, not just how many conversions happen. Meta calls this **value optimization**.

Revenue attributed to ads

Amount spent on ads

= **4.0x**

e.g. \$40k value ÷ \$10k spend

ROAS is a ratio. A 4x ROAS means every \$1 of ad spend returned \$4 of tracked value.

The mechanical difference from a normal "get me leads" campaign: instead of counting each conversion as *1*, every conversion carries a **value number**. Meta's delivery system then chases *total value*. Two people can both "convert," but if one is worth \$4,000 and the other \$400, Meta learns to find more people like the \$4,000 one. You steer this with a **bid strategy** — either **Highest Value** (spend the budget, maximize value) or **ROAS Goal / target ROAS** (keep the return at or above a floor like 3x).

02

How it's structured in Meta

Every Meta campaign is three nested levels. The value/ROAS settings live at specific levels — knowing which matters when you're debugging delivery.

Campaign

THE GOAL

Objective = Sales (formerly "Conversions"). This is where value optimization is unlocked and where the **bid strategy** lives (Highest Value or ROAS Goal). Budget can also sit here (Advantage+ / CBO) so Meta shifts spend to the best ad set automatically.

Ad Set

THE WHO + WHAT COUNTS

The engine room. You set the **optimization event** (which conversion Meta chases — e.g. `Purchase` / a custom event), the **attribution window** (typically 7-day click / 1-day view), the **audience, placements**, and the **budget + schedule**. **This is where the value signal is consumed.**

Ad

THE CREATIVE

The actual image/video, copy, and link people see. Multiple ads per ad set; Meta rotates toward whichever drives the most **value**, not just the most clicks.

Rule of thumb: **Campaign** = the objective & bid strategy · **Ad Set** = the audience & the event/value it optimizes on · **Ad** = the creative.

03

What events get sent to the campaign

Meta can only optimize on what it's told happened. Conversions are reported through two channels that Meta stitches together.

Pixel (browser-side)

JavaScript on your site fires events as they happen in the browser.

- Good for on-page actions: `PageView`, `Lead`, `ViewContent`.

Conversions API — CAPI (server-side)

Your servers send events straight to Meta. Ad-blocker-proof.

- The only way to report **off-site / later** events: a sales call held, an offer accepted

- Blocked by ad-blockers, ITP/cookie limits, and anything that happens *off* the website.

in your CRM.

- Carries richer **customer-match** data → higher match quality → better optimization.

Anatomy of a value event

Whichever channel it comes from, a value-carrying conversion event looks like this. The three fields that make it a "ROAS" event are highlighted:

```
event_name      "Offer_Accepted" # which milestone
value           4000 # ← the dollars Meta optimizes toward
currency        "USD" # ← value is meaningless without it
event_id        "lead_9F3A..." # dedupes Pixel vs CAPI copies
event_time      1754960400 # must fall inside the attribution window
user_data       { em: sha256(email), ... } # ← match back to the ad click
action_source    "system_generated" # CRM / offline origin
```

THREE THINGS THAT QUIETLY BREAK VALUE CAMPAIGNS

1. Deduplication — send the same `event_id` from Pixel and CAPI so one action isn't counted twice. **2. Event Match Quality** — the more hashed identifiers (email, phone, click-id `fbclid` / `fbclid`) you attach, the more events Meta can tie back to a click. **3. The attribution window** — if a deal closes 40 days after the click but your window is 7 days, Meta never gets credit and can't learn from it.

04 The Wonderly value ladder

Your funnel isn't a checkout — the money is decided over a sales cycle. So instead of one `Purchase`, you send an event at **each stage** and attach the dollar value that stage is worth. Meta adds them up per lead.

1

Call 1 scheduled
event: Call1_Scheduled

\$400

\$400

running total: \$400

2

Pending offer

event: Offer_Pending

+ \$900

+ **\$900**

running total: \$1,300

3

Offer accepted

event: Offer_Accepted

+ \$2,700

+ **\$2,700**

running total: \$4,000

A lead that goes all the way is worth...**\$4,000**

Each bar's value is *added* as the lead advances. Meta sees a graded signal, not a single yes/no.

Why send it as three events instead of one \$4,000 event?

Volume vs. value. Meta's algorithm needs roughly **~50 conversions per ad set per week** to exit the "learning phase" and optimize reliably. Accepted offers are rare and slow — you'd almost never hit 50/week on that event alone, so Meta would fly blind. The ladder fixes this:

Top of the ladder = the volume signal

Call 1 scheduled (\$400) happens often enough to feed the algorithm early, fast signal. Meta learns who books calls within hours of the click.

Bottom of the ladder = the value signal

Offer accepted (+\$2,700) is rare but is where the real money is. Its weight teaches Meta which of those early callers actually became customers.

The numbers themselves are **economic weights**, not literal revenue. They encode "a booked call is worth ~\$400 of expected downstream value; reaching a pending offer adds ~\$900 more; an acceptance adds the final ~\$2,700 — a fully-converted lead is worth ~\$4,000 to us." As long as the *ratios* reflect real value, Meta optimizes toward the leads that move all the way down, not the cheap ones that stall at step 1.

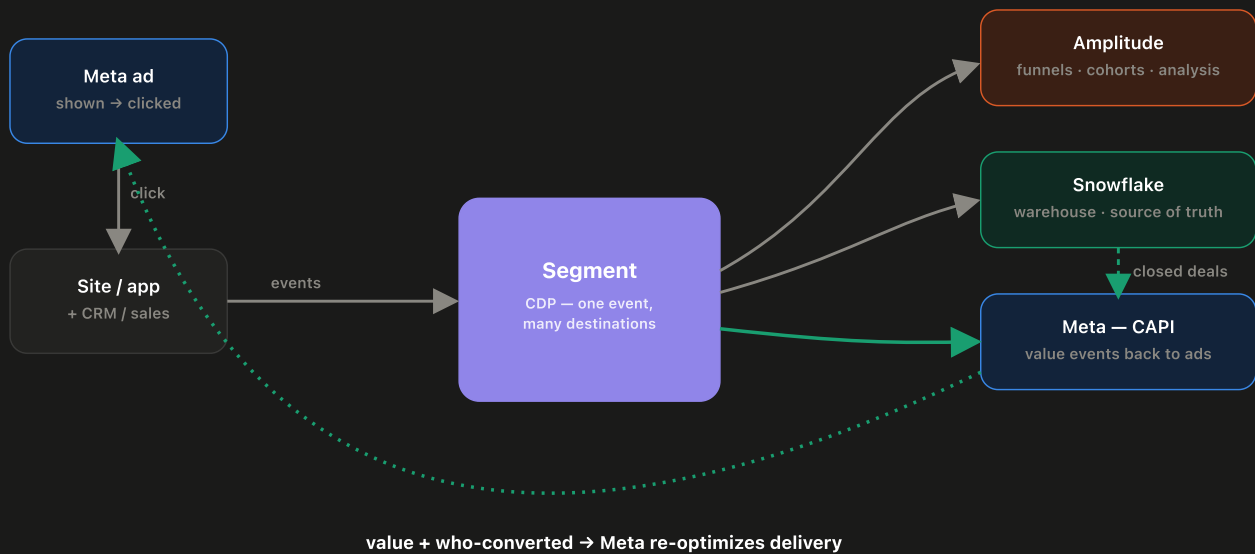
⚠ THE JUDGMENT CALL TO WATCH

If you set the ad set's **optimization event** to `Offer_Accepted`, you get the purest value target but almost no volume → unstable learning. Most teams in a high-ACV funnel optimize on an **earlier, higher-volume event** (Call 1 scheduled, or pending offer) while still *sending value* on all three,

then let ROAS reporting confirm the downstream return. Which stage you optimize on is the main lever to test.

05 How it flows through your stack

You already have the plumbing. Segment is the hub: one event definition fans out to Amplitude (analysis), Snowflake (truth), and Meta (optimization). Here's the whole loop.



Solid grey = raw events flowing out · **aqua** = the value/conversion signal that closes the optimization loop.

Amplitude — read it

Where *you* watch the funnel: conversion rates between Call 1 → pending → accepted, by cohort, campaign, or creative. This is how you sanity-check whether the \$400/\$900/\$2,700 weights still match reality.

Snowflake — the truth

Holds the authoritative funnel + revenue. Late-closing deals (accepted weeks later) are often sent to Meta CAPI **from Snowflake** via a scheduled job / reverse-ETL — that's the dashed "closed deals" arrow. It's how offline acceptances get their \$2,700 back to the ad platform.

Why companies run them

A "more leads" campaign optimizes for the cheapest action. A value campaign optimizes for the outcome that actually pays the bills — which matters most exactly when a lead is cheap but a customer is rare and valuable (your situation).



Optimize for revenue, not vanity volume

Meta chases total dollar value, so it stops buying cheap leads that never buy and starts buying the ones that reach "accepted."



The algorithm finds high-value lookalikes

Feed it \$4,000 acceptances and its machine learning targets people who resemble your best customers — not just your easiest clicks.



Bid to a profit floor

A ROAS Goal lets you say "keep me at $\geq 3\times$ return." Spend scales up only while it stays profitable, and pulls back when it doesn't.



Built for long, high-ACV sales cycles

When the "purchase" is a \$4,000 deal closed days later off-site, value events + CAPI are the only way Meta ever learns what worked.

The 30-second version

STRUCTURE

Campaign (Sales objective + bid strategy) → Ad Set (audience + which event/value it optimizes) → Ad (creative).

SIGNAL

Fire a value event at each funnel stage via Pixel + CAPI: \$400, +\$900, +\$2,700, summing to \$4,000 per fully-converted lead.

LOOP

Segment → Amplitude (watch), Snowflake (truth) → CAPI feeds value back so Meta buys more people who reach "accepted."

Illustrative structure for explaining the concept — event names and the exact stage Meta optimizes on are yours to set in Ads Manager and your Segment tracking plan. The \$400 / +\$900 / +\$2,700 figures are the economic weights you provided.